NovaTech Employee Handbook

Version 2026 - Issued by Human Resources

1. About NovaTech

NovaTech is a software and AI solutions company founded in 2015. Its headquarters are in Cairo, Egypt, and it has two additional offices in Alexandria and Dubai. As of 2026, NovaTech employs about 240 people across eight departments: Engineering, Data & AI, Product, Human Resources, Finance, Marketing, Sales, and IT Security.

NovaTech's mission is to help businesses in the Middle East adopt practical AI tools. Our core values are Customer Focus, Integrity, Continuous Learning, and Teamwork.

2. Working Hours

The official work week is Sunday to Thursday. Standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, including a one-hour lunch break. Employees must be available during core hours, which are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM.

Arriving more than 30 minutes late more than three times in a month triggers a written reminder from the direct manager. Overtime must be approved in advance by the manager and is paid at 1.5 times the hourly rate on weekdays and 2 times on Fridays, Saturdays and official holidays.

3. Leave Policy

Annual leave: Employees with less than 10 years of service receive 21 days of paid annual leave per year. Employees with 10 or more years of service receive 30 days. Leave requests longer than 3 working days must be submitted at least 5 working days in advance through the HR portal.

Carry-over: A maximum of 5 unused annual leave days can be carried over to the next year. Carried-over days expire on March 31.

Sick leave: Employees receive 15 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required if the absence lasts more than 2 consecutive days.

Maternity and paternity leave: Maternity leave is 90 days fully paid. Paternity leave is 5 paid days, to be taken within 30 days of the birth.

Marriage and bereavement: Employees receive 3 paid days for their own marriage and 3 paid days for the death of a first-degree relative.

Unpaid leave: Up to 30 days of unpaid leave per year may be granted with approval from the department head and HR.

4. Remote and Hybrid Work

Employees become eligible for remote work after completing the 3-month probation period. The default hybrid arrangement allows up to 2 remote days per week, agreed with the direct manager. Fully remote work requires written approval from a Vice President.

Employees approved for remote or hybrid work receive a one-time home office allowance of 3,000 EGP to purchase a desk, chair, or monitor. Remote employees must be reachable on Slack and available for video calls during core hours (10:00 AM to 3:00 PM).

Remote work from another country for more than 14 days per year is not allowed without approval from HR and Finance, because of tax and legal implications.

5. Expenses and Travel

All expense claims must be submitted through the finance portal within 30 days of the expense date, with original receipts attached. Claims submitted after 30 days will be rejected.

Approval limits: Direct managers can approve expenses up to 5,000 EGP. Department directors can approve up to 25,000 EGP. Any amount above 25,000 EGP requires approval from the CFO.

Per diem: The domestic meal allowance is 400 EGP per day. For international business travel the per diem is 60 USD per day.

Flights and hotels: Economy class is required for flights shorter than 6 hours. Business class is allowed for flights longer than 6 hours with director approval. Hotel stays are capped at 3,500 EGP per night in Egypt and 150 USD per night abroad.

Reimbursements are paid with the next monthly payroll after approval.

6. Information Security

Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and must be changed every 90 days. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all company accounts, including email, the VPN and the code repository.

Company laptops must have disk encryption enabled. Personal USB drives must not be connected to company devices. Customer data must never be copied to personal cloud storage.

Any suspected security incident, such as a phishing email or a lost device, must be reported to the IT Security team at security@novatech.example within 24 hours.

7. Salary Grades and Bonus

NovaTech uses five salary grades, from G1 to G5. Each grade has a target annual bonus, expressed as a percentage of annual base salary. The bonus is paid in January based on company results and individual performance.

Grade	Level	Target annual bonus
G1	Junior / Associate	5%
G2	Mid-level	8%
G3	Senior	10%
G4	Lead / Manager	15%
G5	Director and above	20%

8. Performance Reviews and Training

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in June and in December. Each review includes a self-assessment, a manager assessment, and a goal-setting conversation. Employees who receive a rating of 'Exceeds Expectations' in both reviews of a year are eligible for a promotion discussion.

Every employee has a yearly training budget of 15,000 EGP, which can be used for courses, certifications, or conferences. Training requests must be approved by the direct manager. Employees who leave NovaTech within 12 months after a training that cost more than 10,000 EGP must repay the cost.

9. Onboarding and Probation

New employees have a probation period of 3 months. During the first week, each new employee is assigned an onboarding buddy and receives a company laptop on day 1. A probation review meeting happens at the end of month 3, and employment is confirmed in writing if the review is successful.

During probation, either side may end the employment with 7 days' notice. After probation, the notice period is 30 days.

10. Contacts

HR Helpdesk: hr@novatech.example (extension 100). IT Security: security@novatech.example (extension 200). Finance Support: finance@novatech.example (extension 300).